Rebuttal to the Argument Against Measure O.

The argument against Measure O ignores the facts.

Rio Vista has demonstrated accountability and responsible financial management. The annual adopted budget specifically spells out how Measure O funds will be utilized each year. 92% supports Fire Department, 7% supports law enforcement , and 1% supports Public Works personnel. These are frontline City employees providing essential services to Rio Vista residents.

Claims of financial management problems are simply unsupported. In fact, Rio Vista's Finance Department consistently earns recognition for excellence in budgeting and financial reporting. For the last five years the City has received the Government Finance Officers Association (GFOA) Certificate of Achievement for Excellence in Financial Reporting, the GFOA Distinguished Budget Presentation, and the California Society of Municipal Finance Officers Operating Budget Excellence Award.

The last five years of Measure O revenues and expenditures can be viewed on the City's website at: https://www.riovistacity.com/clerk/page/measure-o. Should Measure O be extended an oversight committee will annually review revenue and expenditures.

Thanks in part to Measure O funding, the City has maintained the staffing of two fire engine companies, thereby reduced response times; however, to maintain paramedic services at current levels, Measure O must remain in place.

Measure O does not increase the existing ¾-cent sales tax rate. It asks voters whether to continue it for three additional years to maintain essential services.

Retaining adequate paramedic services is critical in a community with no hospital and a median age of 64.

Vote YES on Measure O to protect essential services in Rio Vista.

/s/ Edwin Okamura
Mayor of Rio Vista

/s/ Rick Dolk
Vice Mayor of Rio Vista